
How the six laboratories work

ORIGINAL ILLUSTRATIVE PLAY

These are original engine-assisted study continuations from this course's positions. They are not historical master games and no invented players or tournament results are assigned. The continuations reach roughly move twenty and stop for further practice.

THINK BEFORE REVEALING

At each checkpoint, name the opponent's threat, compare two candidates and calculate a forcing reply. Use a board to replay the sequence. The engine comparison supplies concrete evidence, while the opening explanation supplies a plan.

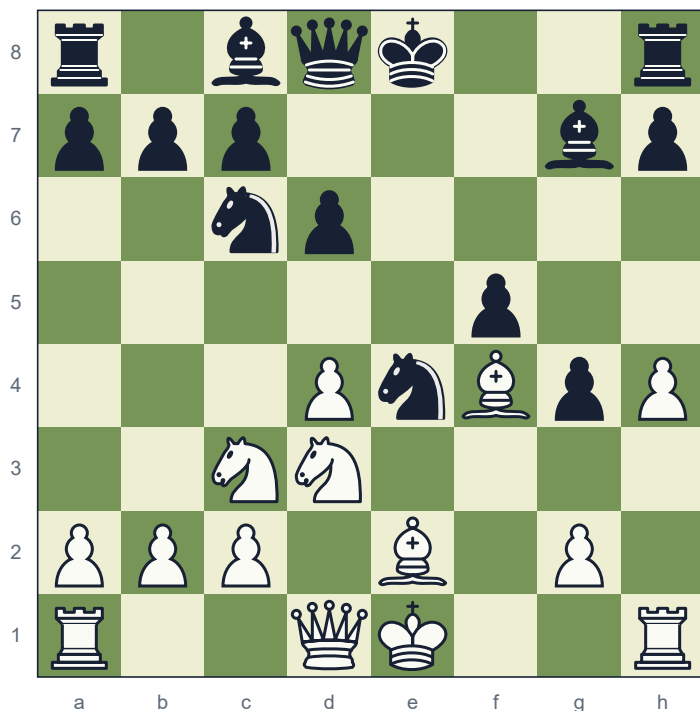
MORE THAN ONE GOOD MOVE

Close engine scores do not establish a unique answer. The finite search can prefer a different move when run longer. Accept another candidate if you can support it with a sound variation and a coherent explanation.

PRACTICE FROM BOTH SIDES

Play each starting position twice, switching colors. Record the first decision you could not explain and compare it with the branch lesson after the game.

KG-LAB-01 / The main choice: meet ...g5 with h4



Laboratory start - White to move

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king e1; central-file pawns c2, d4. Black king e8; central-file pawns f5, d6, c7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

Black can play ...Nf6 against e4 and ...d6 against Ne5. Count the defenders of e4 before chasing f7. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

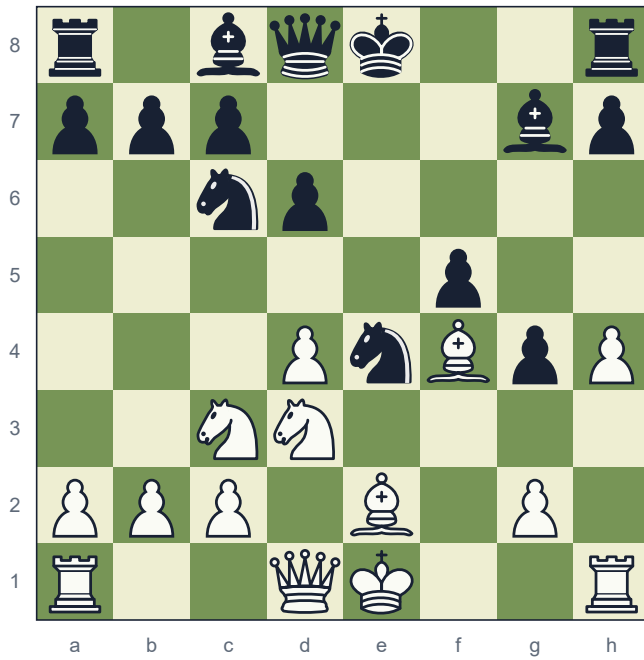
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

OPENING BACKGROUND

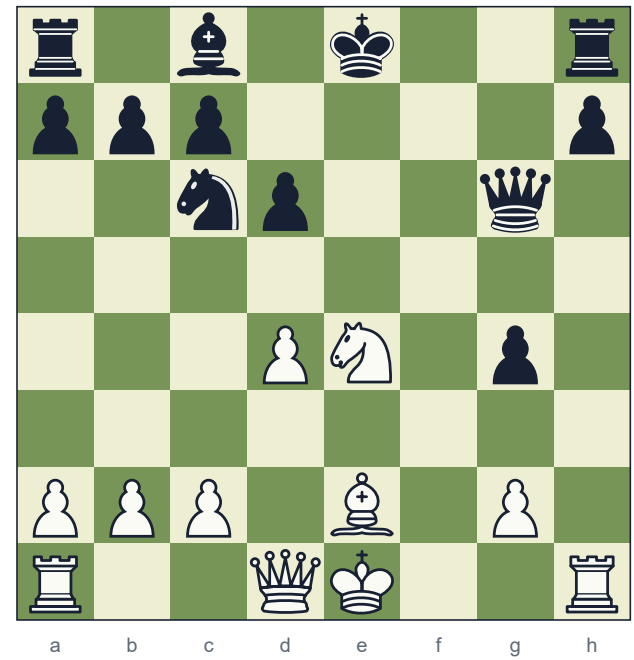
Nf3 prevents an immediate queen check on h4. Black uses ...g5 to keep f4, so h4 attacks the supporting chain. After ...g4 the knight must move; Ne5 takes an active central post.

KG-LAB-01 / play and explain 1

11. Nxe4 fxe4 12. Bg5 Bf6 13. Nf2 Bxg5 14. hxg5 Qxg5 15. Nxe4 Qg6



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. NXE4

The knight captures a knight on e4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

13. NF2

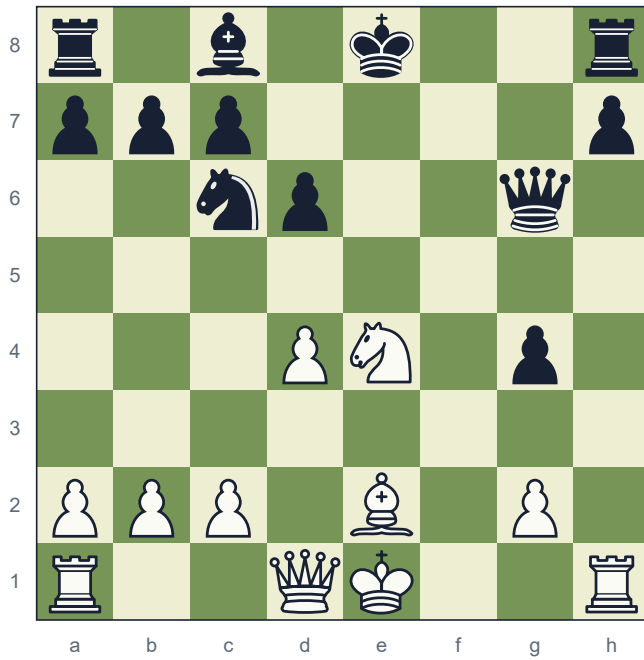
Places the knight on f2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

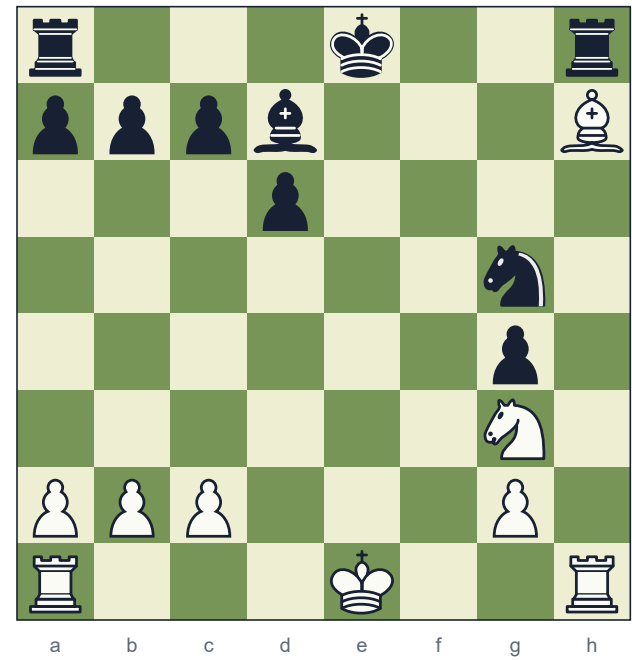
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-01 / play and explain 2

16. Ng3 Bd7 17. Bd3 Qe6+ 18. Qe2 Nxd4 19. Qxe6+ Nxe6 20. Bxh7 Ng5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. NG3

Places the knight on g3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

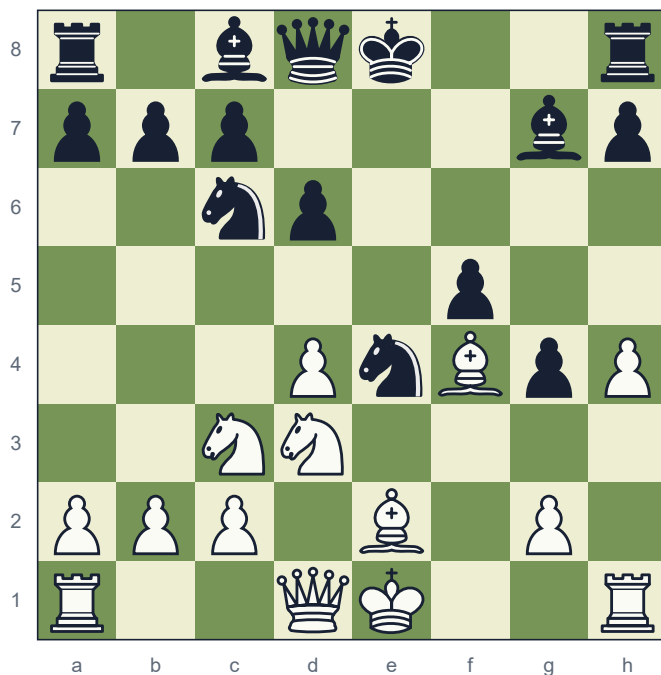
18. QE2

Places the queen on e2, attacking queen on e6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-01 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nxe4 and Bxg4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king e1; central-file pawns c2, d4. Black king e8; central-file pawns f5, d6, c7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NXE4

11. Nxe4 fxe4 Search estimate: -0.94 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BXG4

11. Bxg4 O-O 12. Bf3 Nxd4 13. Ne2 Re8 14. c3 Nxe2 Search estimate: -1.89 from White's perspective.

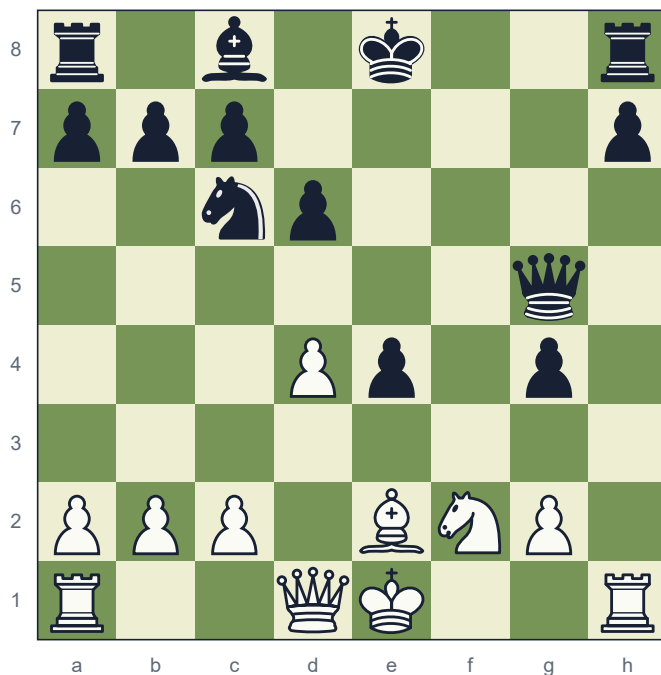
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The knight captures a knight on e4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-01 / decision 2



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nxe4 and d5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king e1; central-file pawns c2, d4. Black king e8; central-file pawns e4, d6, c7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NXE4

15. Nxe4 Qg6 16. Ng3 Bd7 17. Qd3 O-O-O 18. Qxg6 hxg6 Search estimate: -0.82 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE D5

15. d5 Ne5 16. Nxe4 Qg6 17. Ng3 h5 18. Qd4 h4 Search estimate: -1.55 from White's perspective.

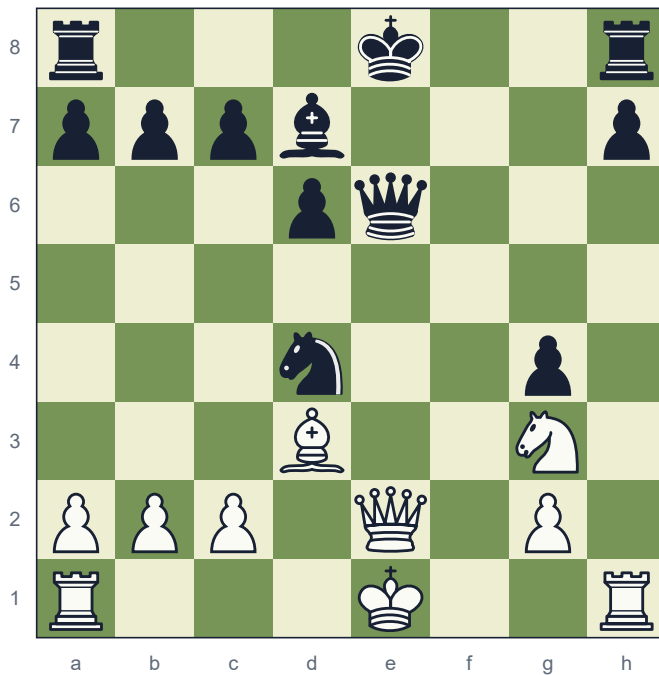
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The knight captures a pawn on e4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-01 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Qxe6+ and Qe4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king e1; central-file pawns c2. Black king e8; central-file pawns d6, c7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE QXE6+

19. Qxe6+ Nxe6 20. Bxh7 Nf4 21. Kd2 Nxg2 22. Raf1 Bc6 Search estimate: -0.92 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE QE4

19. Qe4 Bc6 Search estimate: -1.64 from White's perspective.

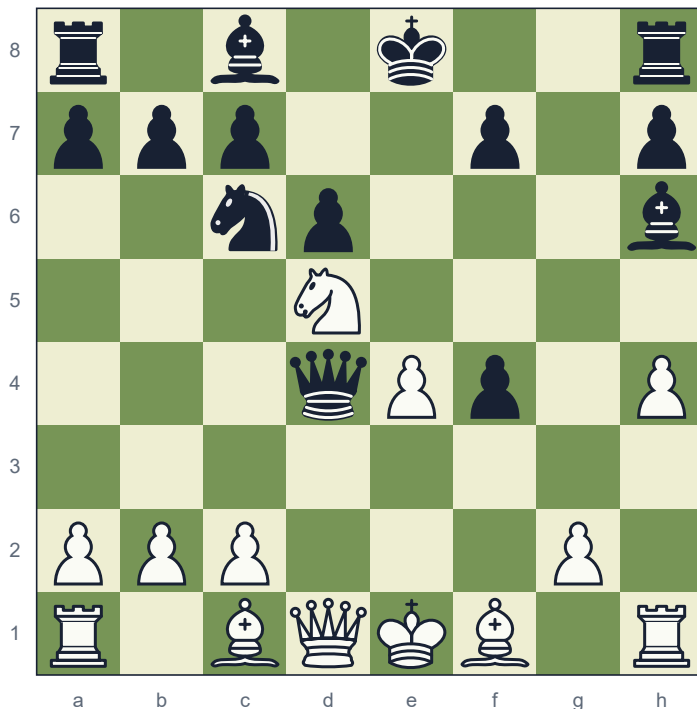
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The queen captures a queen on e6. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-02 / Kieseritzky: an immediate ...d6



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

Black attacks Ne5 with the d-pawn, but the knight can capture the advanced g4 pawn while escaping. This concrete resource is stronger than mechanically retreating to d3 in this exact position.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king e1; central-file pawns c2, e4. Black king e8; central-file pawns f4, d6, c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

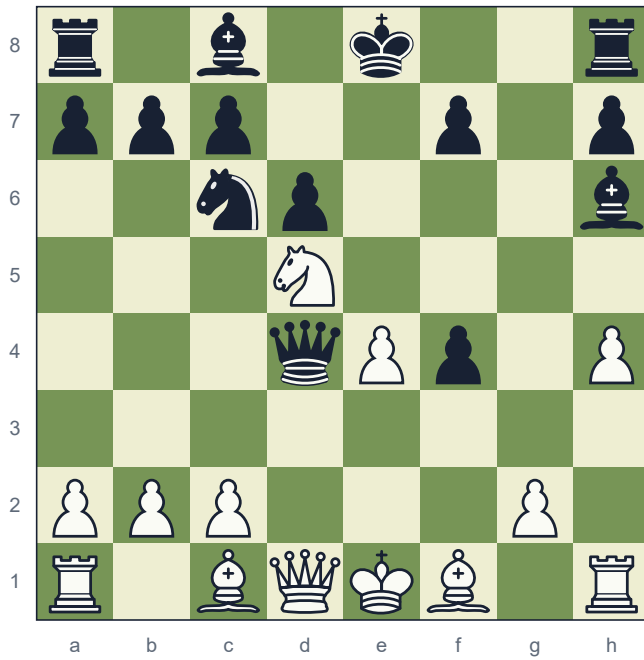
A similar position with an extra black developing move can change the tactics. Do not treat Nxg4 as universal whenever ...d6 attacks Ne5. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

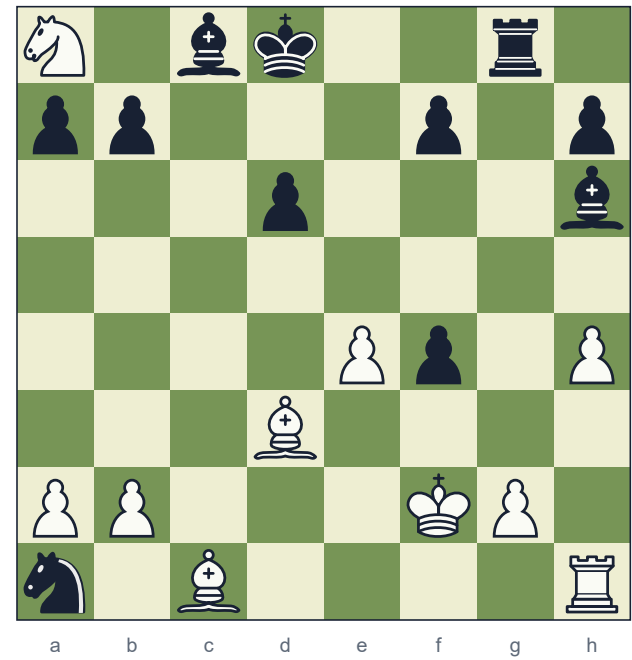
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KG-LAB-02 / play and explain 1

11. Nxc7+ Kd8 12. Qxd4 Nxd4 13. Nxa8 Nxc2+ 14. Kf2 Nxa1 15. Bd3 Rg8



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. NXC7+

The knight captures a pawn on c7. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

13. NXA8

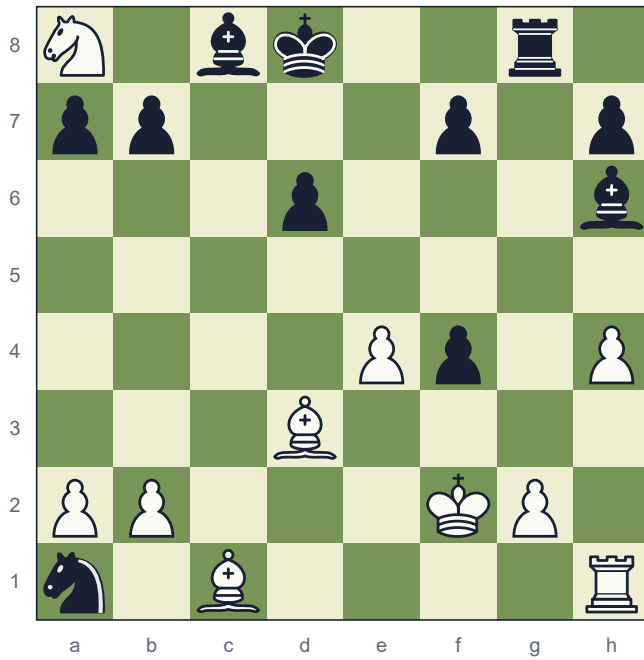
The knight captures a rook on a8. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

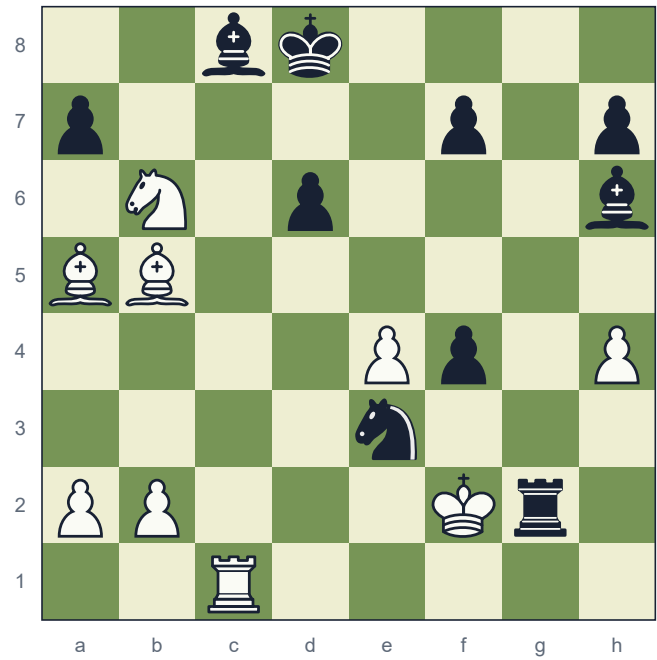
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-02 / play and explain 2

16. Bd2 Rg3 17. Bb5 Nc2 18. Rc1 Ne3 19. Ba5+ b6 20. Nxb6 Rxd2+



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move - in check

16. BD2

Places the bishop on d2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

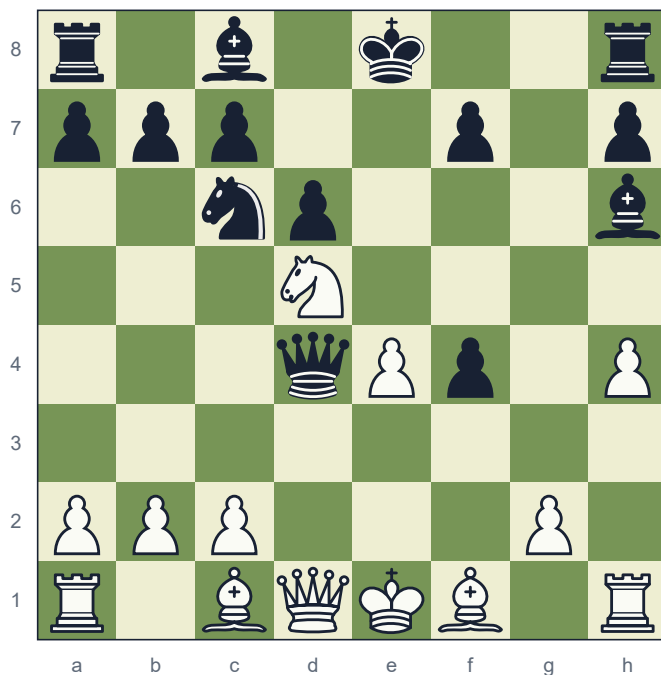
18. RC1

Places the rook on c1, attacking knight on c2. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-02 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nxc7+ and Qxd4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king e1; central-file pawns c2, e4. Black king e8; central-file pawns f4, d6, c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NXC7+

11. Nxc7+ Kd8 Search estimate: +0.31 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE QXD4

11. Qxd4 Nxd4 12. Nxc7+ Kd8 13. Nxa8 Nxc2+ 14. Kf2 Nxa1 Search estimate: +0.32 from White's perspective.

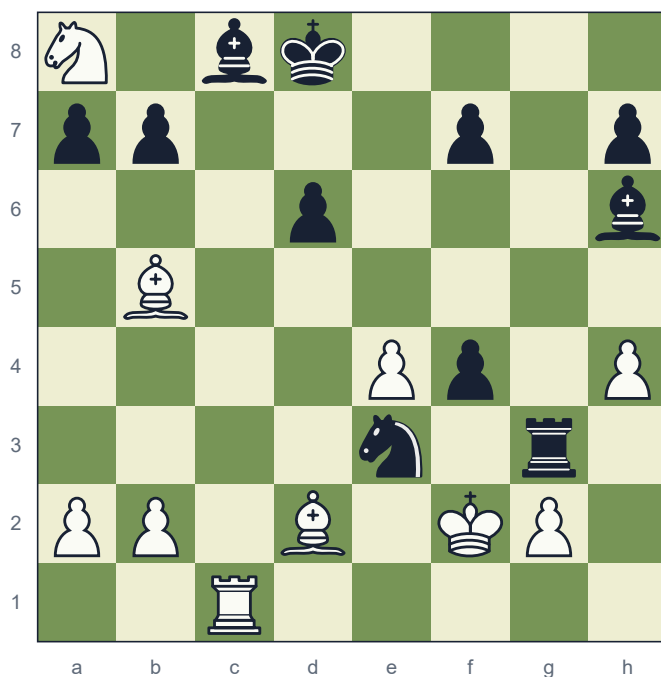
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The knight captures a pawn on c7. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-02 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Ba5+ and Bxe3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king f2; central-file pawns e4. Black king d8; central-file pawns f4, d6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BA5+

19. Ba5+ b6 20. Nxb6 Rxb6 21. Ke1 axb6 22. Bxb6+ Ke7 Search estimate: +0.02 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BXE3

19. Bxe3 Rxe3 Search estimate: -0.55 from White's perspective.

EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Gives check with the bishop on a5. The opponent must answer the check; inspect legal king moves, captures and blocks.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-03 / Modern Defense: ...d5 at once



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

Black exchanges central pawns and develops toward the returned material. Bc4 creates pressure while White builds a useful d4 center.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, d4. Black king c8; central-file pawns c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

Black can exchange pieces and neutralize the initiative. Do not sacrifice more material merely because the opening began as a gambit. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

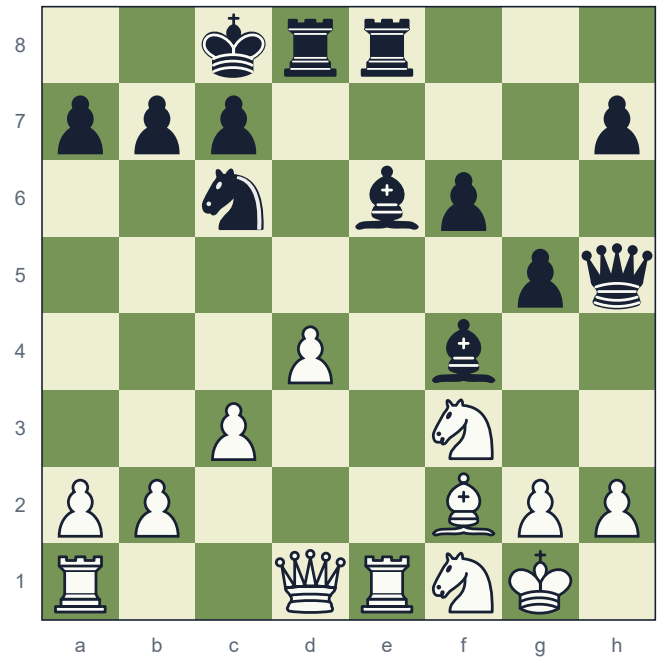
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KG-LAB-03 / play and explain 1

11. Nbd2 Bd6 12. c3 Rhe8 13. Re1 f6 14. Bf2 Bf4 15. Nf1 g5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. NBD2

Develops the queen knight while leaving the c-pawn free. The knight supports e4 and may seek c4 or a route through f1.

13. RE1

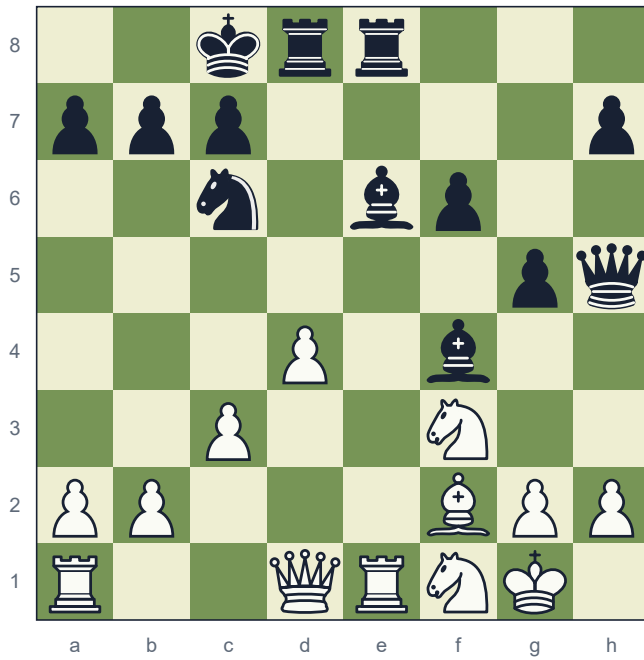
Places the rook on the e-file, commonly supporting e4 or preparing pressure against an opposing king or central pawn.

REASSESS

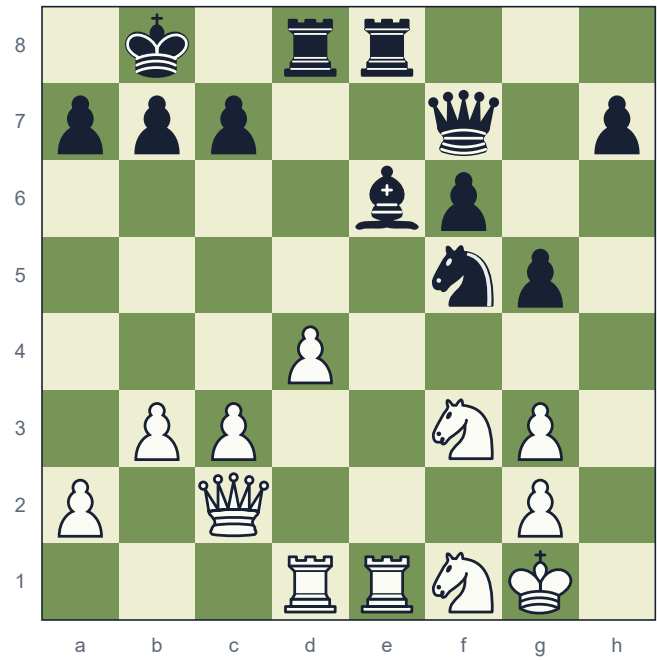
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-03 / play and explain 2

16. Qc2 Kb8 17. Bg3 Bxg3 18. hxg3 Qf7 19. b3 Ne7 20. Rad1 Nf5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. QC2

Places the queen on c2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

18. HXG3

The pawn captures a bishop on g3. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-03 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nbd2 and c3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, d4. Black king c8; central-file pawns c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NBD2

11. Nbd2 Bd6 12. Ne4 Be7 13. c3 Rhe8 14. Ng3 Qg6 Search estimate: -0.64 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE C3

11. c3 f6 12. Re1 Bd6 13. Nbd2 Rhe8 14. Bf2 g5 Search estimate: -0.68 from White's perspective.

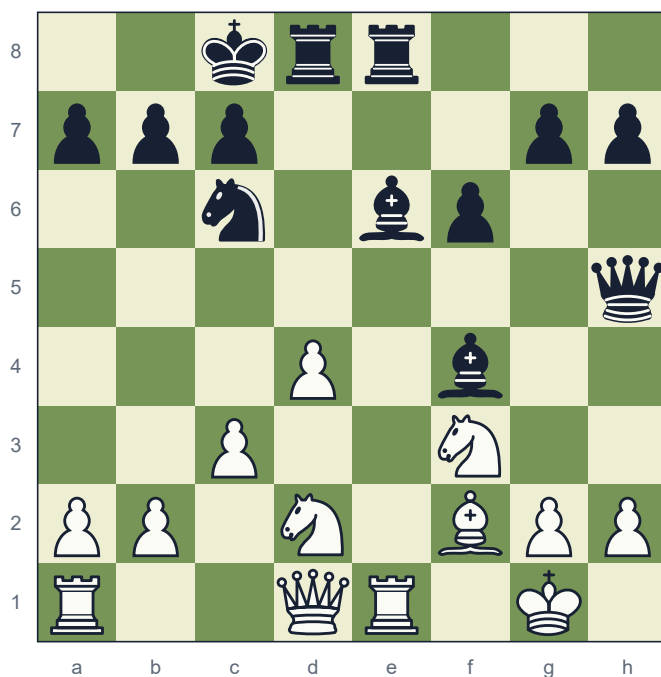
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Develops the queen knight while leaving the c-pawn free. The knight supports e4 and may seek c4 or a route through f1.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-03 / decision 2



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nf1 and Bg3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c3, d4. Black king c8; central-file pawns f6, c7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE NF1

15. Nf1 Bd5 16. Rxe8 Rxe8 17. Ng3 Bxg3 18. hxg3 Nd8 Search estimate: -0.63 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BG3

15. Bg3 Bh6 Search estimate: -0.72 from White's perspective.

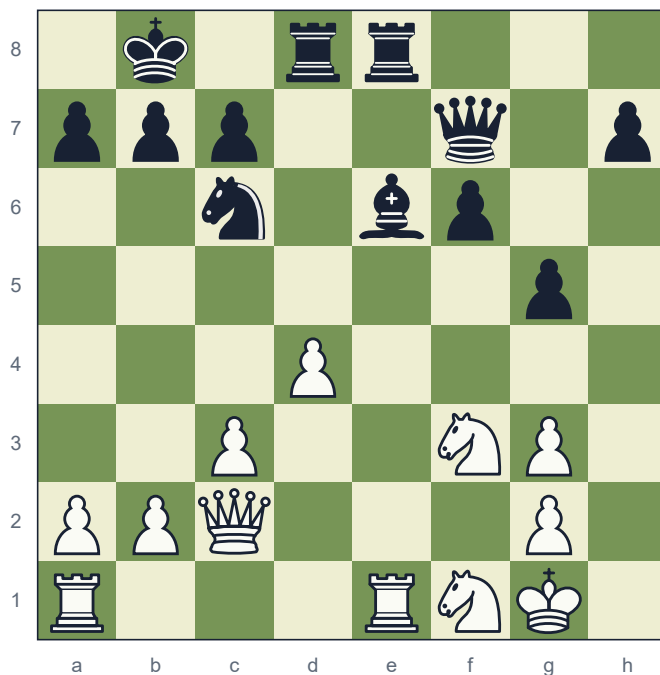
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the knight on f1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-03 / decision 3



COMPARE CANDIDATES

b3 and Ne3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c3, d4. Black king b8; central-file pawns f6, c7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE B3

19. b3 Ne7 20. Rad1 h5 21. c4 Bg4 22. Qf2 Nf5 Search estimate: -0.47 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE NE3

19. Ne3 h5 Search estimate: -0.74 from White's perspective.

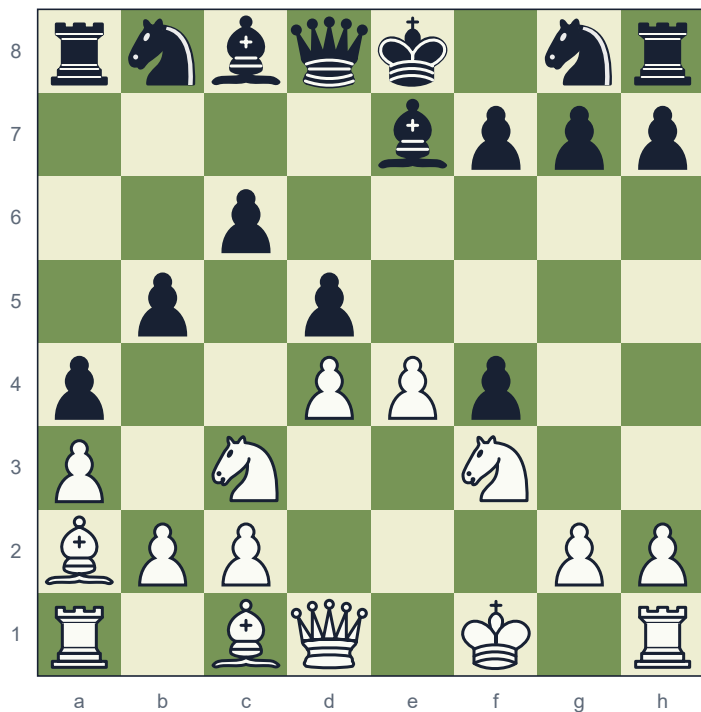
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Prepares a fianchetto and changes the long diagonal. Check the bishop and corner rook before assuming the next developing move is safe.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-04 / Cunningham: meet the bishop check



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

The bishop reaches h4 with check along the diagonal to e1. Kf1 answers it without pushing more kingside pawns, but permanently gives up castling.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king f1; central-file pawns c2, d4, e4. Black king e8; central-file pawns f4, d5, c6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

Black can open the center with ...d5. Do not continue a routine castling plan after the king has moved. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

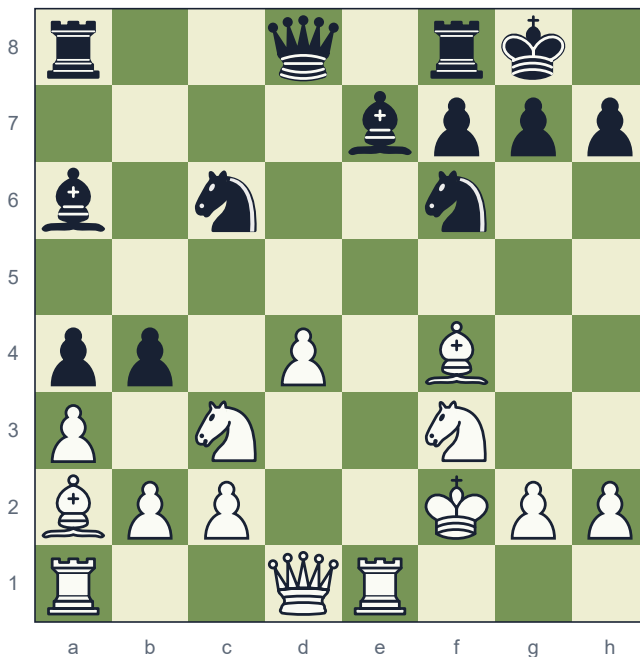
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KG-LAB-04 / play and explain 1

11. exd5 Nf6 12. dxc6 Ba6 13. Kf2 Nxc6 14. Re1 O-O 15. Bxf4 b4



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. EXD5

The pawn captures a pawn on d5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

13. KF2

Places the king on f2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

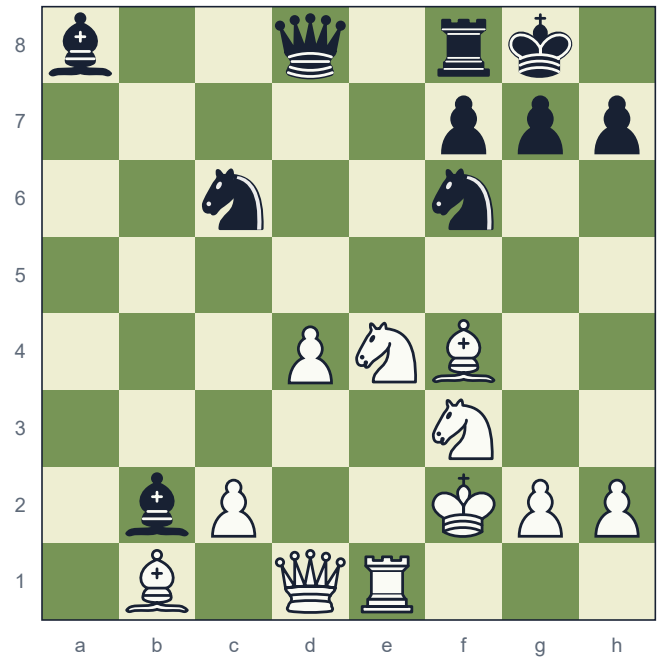
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-04 / play and explain 2

16. Ne4 bxa3 17. bxa3 Bxa3 18. Bb1 Bb2 19. Rxa4 Bb7 20. Rxa8 Bxa8



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. NE4

Places the knight on e4, attacking knight on f6. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

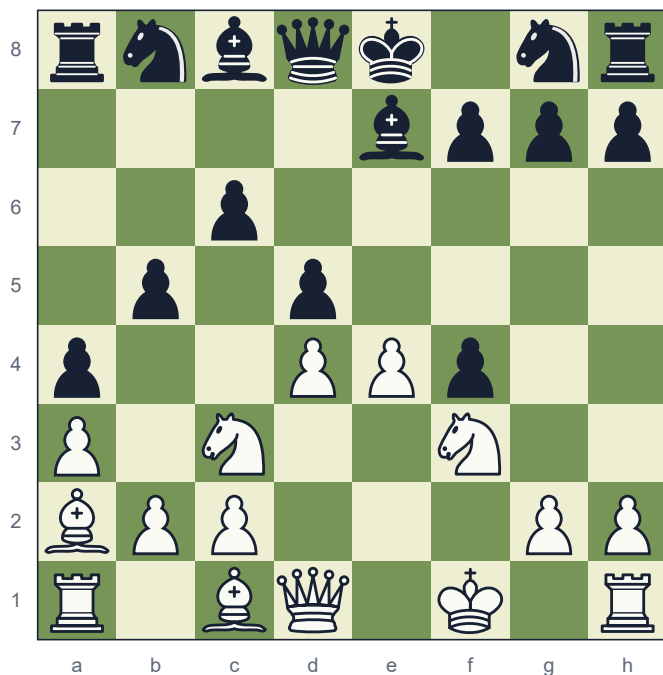
18. BB1

Places the bishop on b1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-04 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

exd5 and Bxf4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king f1; central-file pawns c2, d4, e4. Black king e8; central-file pawns f4, d5, c6, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE EXD5

11. exd5 Search estimate: +0.17 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BXF4

11. Bxf4 Nf6 12. exd5 O-O 13. dxc6 Nxc6 14. Nxb5 Na7 Search estimate: +0.02 from White's perspective.

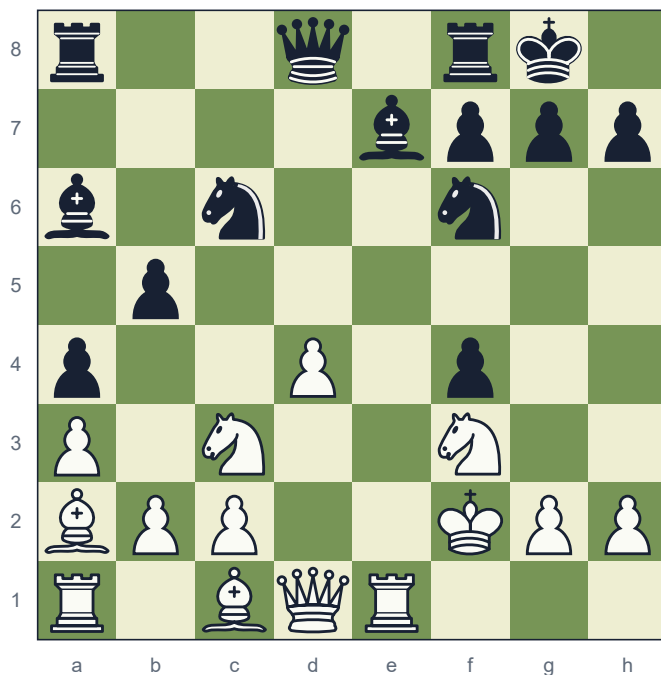
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The pawn captures a pawn on d5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-04 / decision 2



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bxf4 and Kg1. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king f2; central-file pawns c2, d4. Black king g8; central-file pawns f4, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BXF4

15. Bxf4 b4 16. Ne4 bxa3 17. bxa3 Bxa3 18. Bb1 Bb2 Search estimate: +0.53 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE KG1

15. Kg1 Bd6 16. Ne5 Qb6 17. Bxf4 Qxd4+ 18. Qxd4 Nxd4 Search estimate: +0.00 from White's perspective.

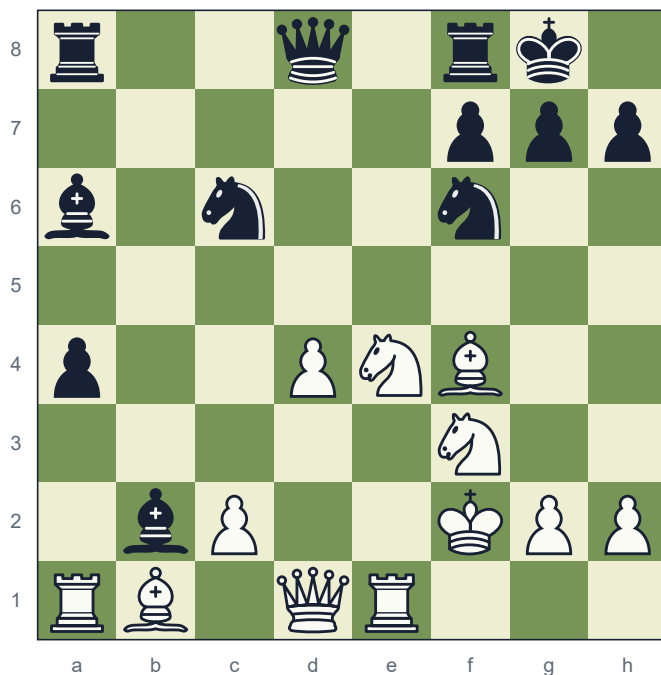
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The bishop captures a pawn on f4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-04 / decision 3



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Rxa4 and Nxf6+. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king f2; central-file pawns c2, d4. Black king g8; central-file pawns f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE Rxa4

19. Rxa4 Bb7 Search estimate: +0.08 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE Nxf6+

19. Nxf6+ Qxf6 20. Bg5 Bxd4+ 21. Qxd4 Qxf3+ 22. gxf3 Nxd4 Search estimate: -0.06 from White's perspective.

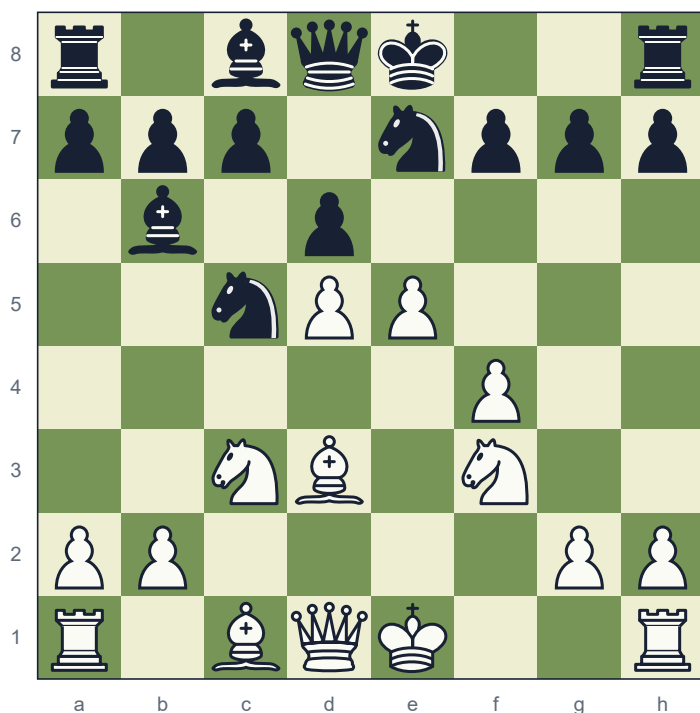
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The rook captures a pawn on a4. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-05 / Classical Declined: ...Bc5



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

White uses c3 to support d4 while the bishop keeps pressure on the king side. Exchanging in the center gives White space but opens lines.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king e1; central-file pawns f4, d5, e5. Black king e8; central-file pawns d6, c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

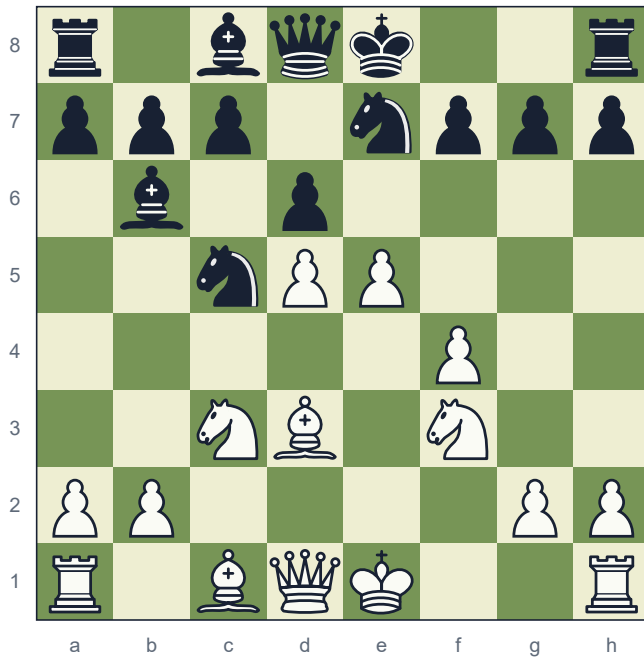
The c5-b6 bishop watches the sensitive f2 square. Capturing e5 at the wrong time may permit ...Qh4+ and a king attack. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

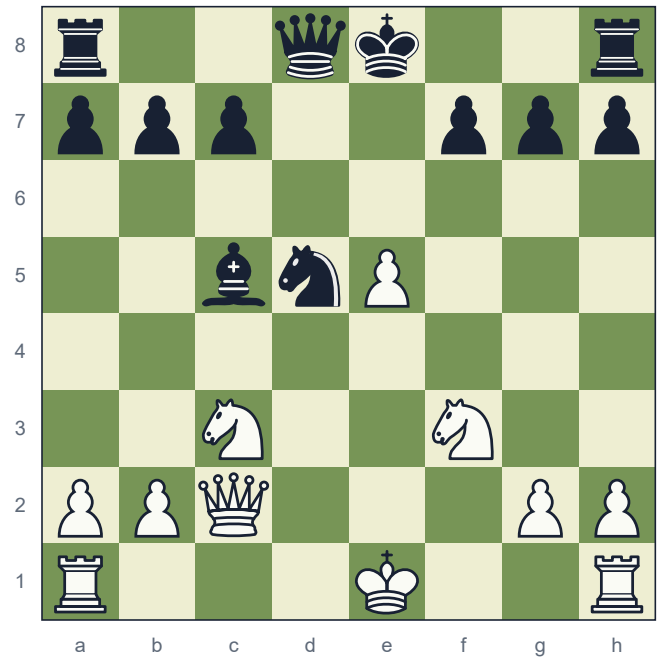
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KG-LAB-05 / play and explain 1

11. Bc2 Bf5 12. Be3 dxe5 13. fxe5 Bxc2 14. Qxc2 Nxd5 15. Bxc5 Bxc5



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. BC2

Places the bishop on c2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

13. FXE5

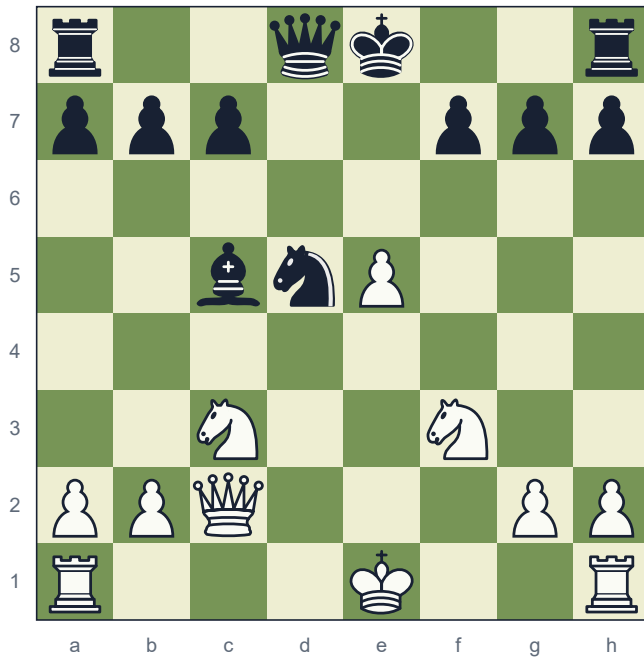
The pawn captures a pawn on e5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

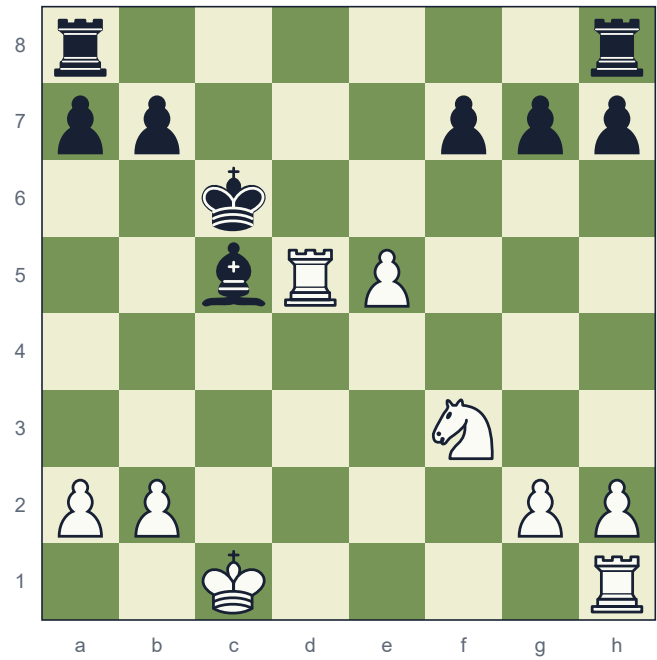
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-05 / play and explain 2

16. O-O-O c6 17. Nxd5 cxd5 18. Qa4+ Qd7 19. Qxd7+ Kxd7 20. Rxd5+ Kc6



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. O-O-O

Moves the king toward shelter and brings a rook toward the center. Check the resulting open lines before assuming the king is safe.

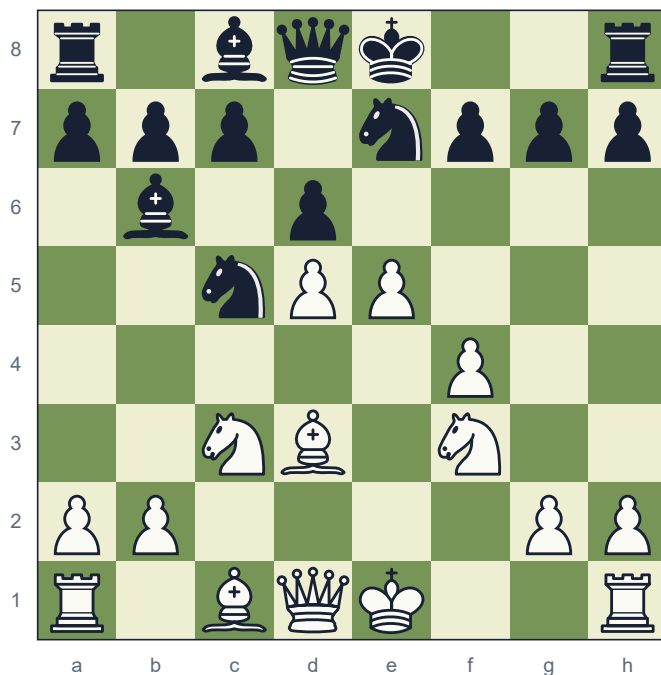
18. QA4+

Gives check with the queen on a4. The opponent must answer the check; inspect legal king moves, captures and blocks.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-05 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bc2 and Bc4. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king e1; central-file pawns f4, d5, e5. Black king e8; central-file pawns d6, c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BC2

11. Bc2 Search estimate: +0.51 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BC4

11. Bc4 O-O 12. Be3 c6 13. dxc6 Nxc6 14. Qxd6 Qxd6 Search estimate: +0.12 from White's perspective.

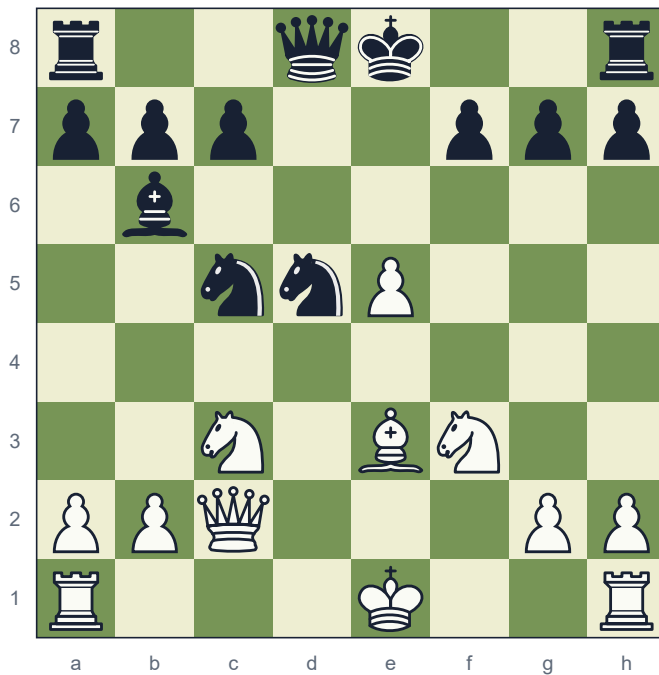
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the bishop on c2. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-05 / decision 2



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bxc5 and O-O-O. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king e1; central-file pawns e5. Black king e8; central-file pawns c7, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BXC5

15. Bxc5 Bxc5 Search estimate: +0.10 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE O-O-O

15. O-O-O Nxe3 16. Rxd8+ Rxd8 17. Qe2 O-O 18. Kb1 Ne6 Search estimate: +0.07 from White's perspective.

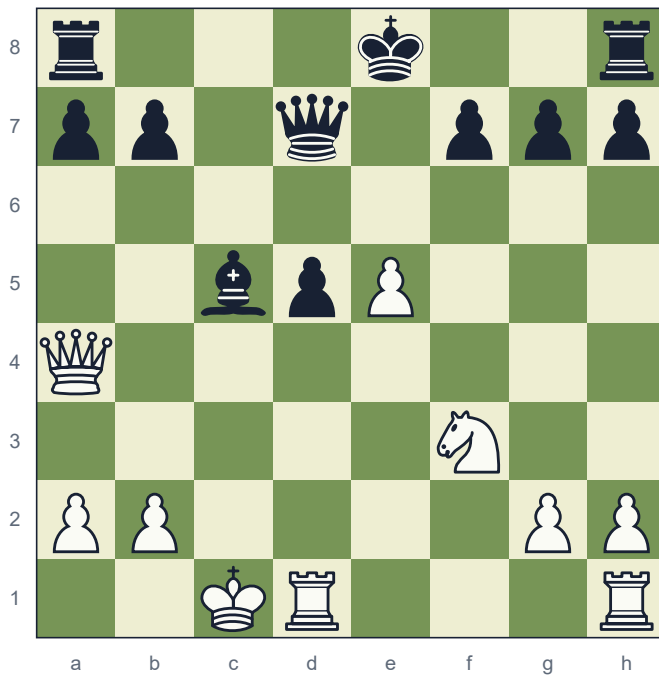
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The bishop captures a knight on c5. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-05 / decision 3



COMPARE CANDIDATES

Qxd7+ and Qb3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king c1; central-file pawns e5. Black king e8; central-file pawns d5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE QXD7+

19. Qxd7+ Kxd7 20. Rxd5+ Kc6 21. Rhd1 Rac8 22. R5d3 Rhe8 Search estimate: +0.00 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE QB3

19. Qb3 Rd8 Search estimate: -1.25 from White's perspective.

EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

The queen captures a queen on d7. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-06 / Falkbeer: the ...e4 wedge



Laboratory start - White to move

OPENING BACKGROUND

Black ignores the offered f-pawn and builds an advanced e4 wedge. d3 challenges it directly; exchanges change the position into a development battle.

READ THE CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

OPENING CONCERN TO RECHECK

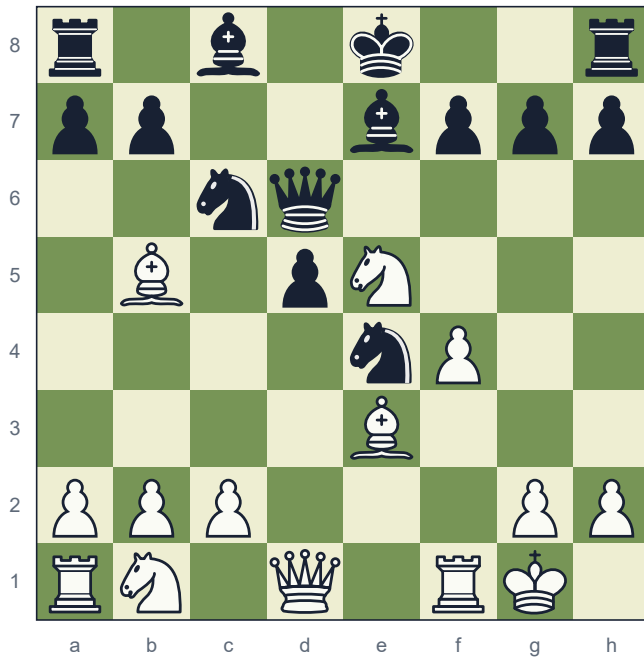
Black's development can be rapid and the king remains on e1. A greedy attempt to keep every extra pawn can allow a central attack. Decide which parts still apply after the moves already played.

BEFORE PLAYING

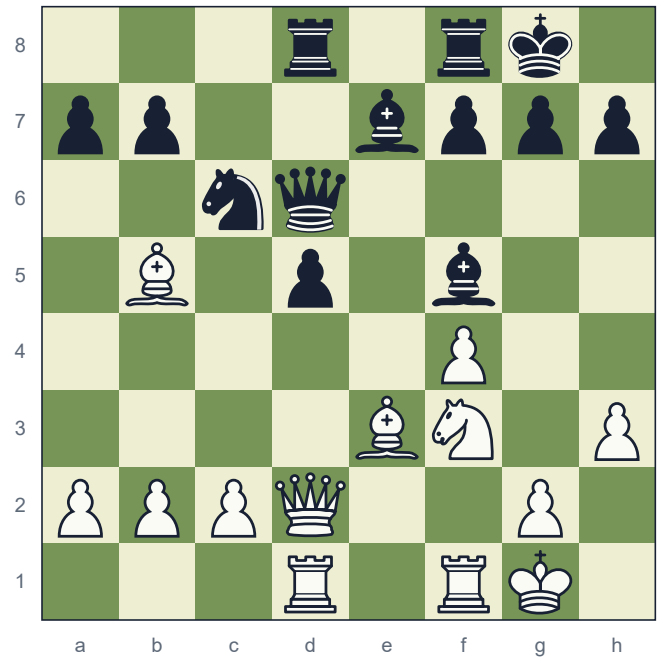
Write a candidate move and a reply for the opponent. Name the pawn break each side would like to achieve. The continuation on the following pages is one checked illustration, not a forced script.

KG-LAB-06 / play and explain 1

11. Nd2 Nxd2 12. Qxd2 O-O 13. Nf3 Bg4 14. h3 Bf5 15. Rad1 Rad8



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

11. ND2

Places the knight on d2, attacking knight on e4. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

13. NF3

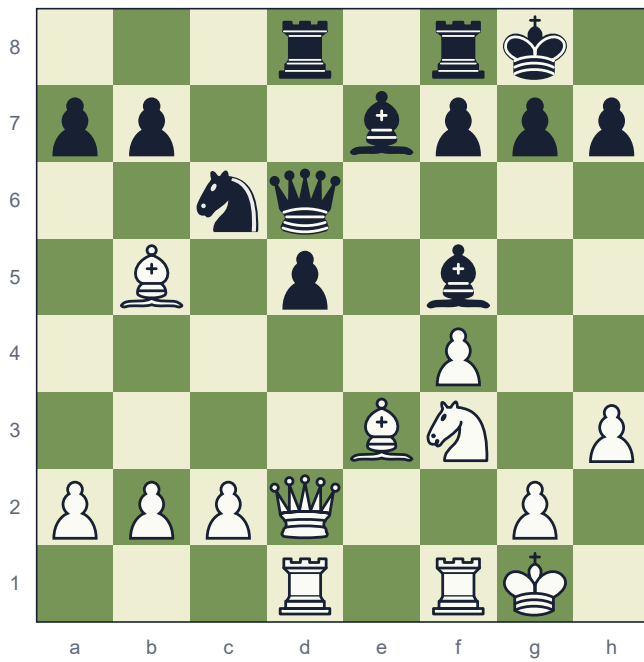
Develops the king knight toward e5 and d4. In the King's Gambit it also controls h4, making an immediate queen check there unattractive.

REASSESS

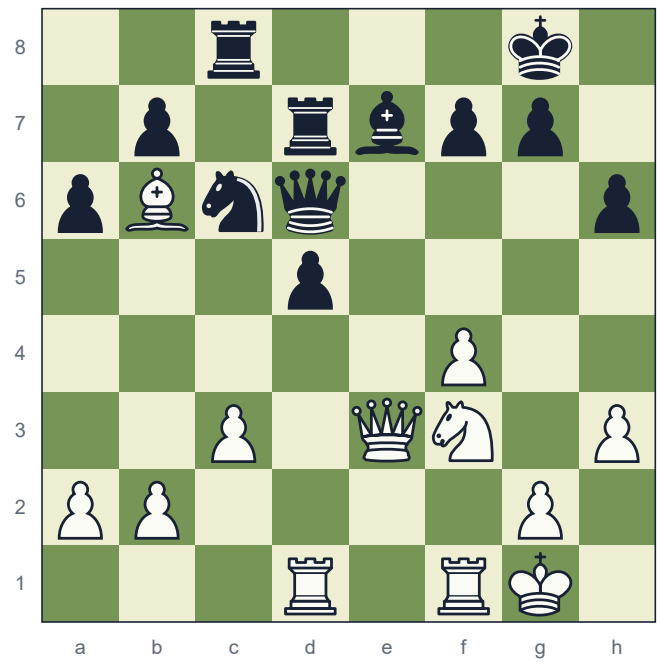
Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-06 / play and explain 2

16. c3 a6 17. Bd3 Bxd3 18. Qxd3 h6 19. Bb6 Rd7 20. Qe3 Rc8



Before this segment - White to move



After this segment - White to move

16. C3

Places the pawn on c3. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

18. QXD3

The queen captures a bishop on d3. Calculate the best reply before assuming a recapture, then recount material and opened lines.

REASSESS

Name the material balance, the most active piece and the next pawn break. If the center changed, explain why the original plan may need to change too.

KG-LAB-06 / decision 1



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Nd2 and Bd3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f4. Black king e8; central-file pawns d5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE ND2

11. Nd2 Nxd2 12. Qxd2 O-O 13. Nf3 Bf5 14. c3 Be4 Search estimate: +0.03 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE BD3

11. Bd3 Nxe5 Search estimate: -0.25 from White's perspective.

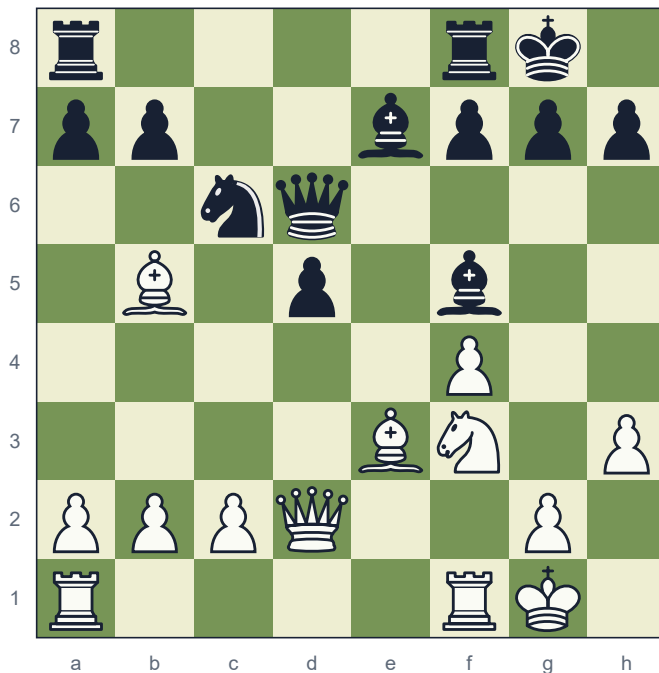
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the knight on d2, attacking knight on e4. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-06 / decision 2



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Rad1 and c3. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c2, f4. Black king g8; central-file pawns d5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE RAD1

15. Rad1 Qg6 Search estimate: +0.13 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE C3

15. c3 h6 16. Rad1 Be4 17. Bd3 Qe6 18. Nd4 Nxd4 Search estimate: +0.04 from White's perspective.

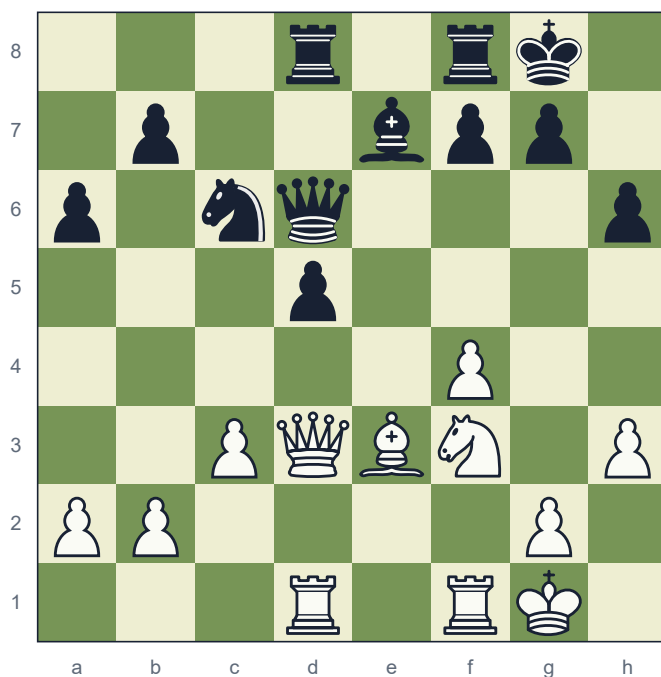
EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the rook on d1. Compare its activity and safety with its previous square, then use the branch explanation to connect the move to a plan.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.

KG-LAB-06 / decision 3



White to move

COMPARE CANDIDATES

Bb6 and Qf5. Before reading the continuations, explain a useful purpose for each and calculate the opponent's most forcing reply.

CURRENT POSITION

White king g1; central-file pawns c3, f4. Black king g8; central-file pawns d5, f7. Compare the pawn contacts and opened files before choosing a move.

CANDIDATE BB6

19. Bb6 Rd7 20. Qe3 Rc8 21. Rd3 Qg6 22. Rfd1 Bd6 Search estimate: +0.16 from White's perspective.

CANDIDATE QF5

19. Qf5 Bf6 20. Nh2 Ne7 21. Qh5 Rfe8 22. Ng4 g6 Search estimate: +0.08 from White's perspective.

EXPLAIN THE PREFERRED MOVE

Places the bishop on b6, attacking rook on d8. A legal capture may still be unsound if the target is defended.

HOW TO INTERPRET THIS

The scores compare these candidates in one finite search. Close values mean the explanation and practical comfort matter; they do not imply a unique winning move. Replay both lines and identify the first concrete difference.